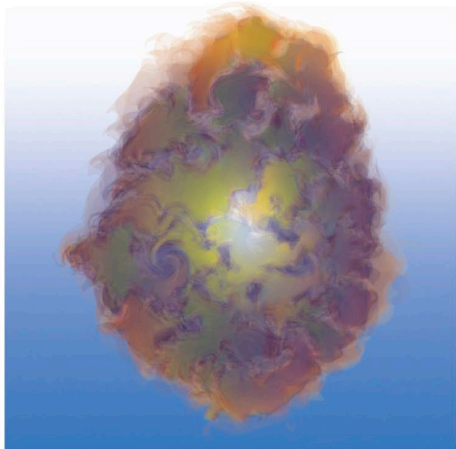


What is a star?

There are billions of stars in the Universe. Stars are gigantic balls of glowing gas, which live for millions and millions of years. There are two main gases inside a star—hydrogen and helium. A star uses its gases to produce heat and light. The Sun is a star, and we feel its heat and light on Earth.

In the beginning

Stars are born in spinning clouds made of gas with a little bit of dust mixed in. A force called gravity pulls the gas and dust together, forming vast clouds. The spinning clouds then shrink and form ball shapes.



Star turns

These spinning balls of gas and dust are stars at the start of their lives. If a ball spins slowly it will produce one star. If it spins fast, twin stars are born. Medium spin will produce a star with planets—this is what happened when the Sun was born.

